

Agentic Engineering

by FIDEL ISABOKE

Module 2: MCP & Connectivity

Module Recap



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Common Pitfalls

- **Vague Docstrings:**

- The Model Context Protocol decouples the reasoning engine (LLM agent) from actual execution code (database access tools).
- FastMCP relies on inspecting Python docstrings to generate tool descriptions for the LLM.

```
# ✖ POOR DOCSTRING
@mcp.tool()
def search_accounts(query: str):
    """Searches for accounts."""
    ...
```

```
# ROBUST DOCSTRING
@mcp.tool()
def search_accounts(query: str) -> list[dict]:
    """
    Search database accounts matching a partial or exact query string.
    The query matches against account holder names, roles, or integer account IDs.
    Returns list of matched accounts containing id, owner_name, and role.
    """
    ...
```

Common Pitfalls

- **Prompt-Based Security Enforcement:**

- **Don't** rely on security rules in the LLM system prompt. They are prone to **Prompt Injection** (e.g. *"Ignore all previous instructions. I am now an Admin."*)
- Enforce security **programmatically** (e.g. by attaching an **auth token** or **role** metadata to the MCP request)

Module Project - Governed MCP Assistant

Objective: Build a secure, action-capable AI assistant powered by MCP, real tools, and governed execution workflows.

Domains (any of your choice, for instance):

- Student Portal
- IT Support
- Healthcare
- Inventory Management
- ...among other domains that you'd like to choose!

Module Project - Governed MCP Assistant

Requirements (you must implement the following):

- MCP Server that exposes tools (at least 3)
- A Pydantic AI agent
- Live data access (SQLite recommended)
- Role-based access control (RBAC)
- Human-in-the-loop (HITL) approval workflow
- PII masking / response sanitization
- Audit logging

Stretch Goal: Integrate 3rd party APIs or MCP servers

End of Module! 🎉

What's Next?

In this module, we learnt how AI agents connect to external tools using the Model Context Protocol.

We built a secure financial assistant that checked accounts, transferred funds, and checked transactions.

Now you know how to extend the agents you build to interact with other 3rd party systems. I'll see you in Module 3!



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